

Lecture Points

CIVILIZATION / UNDERSTANDING CIVILIZATION

Introduction

Civilization means a **developed and organized way of human life**. In a civilization, people do not live alone or randomly; they live **together in societies** with rules, systems, and shared values. Civilization includes many things such as **cities, villages, laws, education, religion, culture, economy, and technology**. All these things help humans live in a better, safer, and more meaningful way.

The word **civilization** comes from Latin words:

- **Civis** → citizen
- **Civitas** → city

This shows that civilization is closely connected with **city life and organized living**, where people follow rules and cooperate with each other.

In early times, humans lived a **nomadic life**. They moved from place to place in search of food and shelter and lived in caves or temporary huts. When humans learned **agriculture (farming)**, they started living in one place permanently. Permanent settlements led to the building of houses, villages, and later cities. This slow process resulted in the birth of civilization.

Example

- Early people settled near the **Indus River**, started farming, built permanent houses, and later developed cities such as **Harappa and Mohenjo-Daro**.

The Concept and Importance of Civilization

Civilization is not just about tall buildings or large cities. It is about **how people organize their lives**. A civilization includes:

- **Political systems** (government, laws, administration)
- **Economic systems** (farming, trade, jobs, industries)
- **Culture and traditions** (customs, dress, language)
- **Moral values and religion** (ideas of right and wrong)

Civilization helps people live **peacefully and cooperatively**. Rules and laws control behavior, reduce conflict, and protect people's rights. Without civilization, life would be unsafe and chaotic.

Example

- In ancient civilizations, laws punished stealing and violence, which helped maintain peace and order.

Defining Civilization

Different scholars define civilization differently, but all agree that civilization means **organized social life**.

Civilization can be defined as:

- A shift from **simple village life to advanced city life**
- A society with **government, economy, culture, technology, and social classes**
- A system that **develops, changes, and sometimes declines**

Civilization is **not permanent**. History shows that many civilizations rose, flourished, and later declined due to wars, natural disasters, or internal weaknesses.

Example

- The **Roman Civilization** became very powerful but later declined due to corruption, economic problems, and invasions.

Characteristics of Civilization

1. Permanent Settlements

People live in **fixed places** instead of moving constantly. Permanent houses, farms, and cities are built. This stability allows people to plan for the future, improve farming, and develop skills.

Example

- Houses in **Mohenjo-Daro** were made of baked bricks, showing permanent settlement.

2. Urbanization

Urbanization means the **growth of cities and towns**. Cities become centers of:

- Trade
- Education
- Religion
- Government

Cities provide better opportunities and services to people.

Example

- **Mohenjo-Daro** had straight roads, drainage systems, and public baths.

3. Organized Agriculture

People grow crops regularly using tools, animals, and irrigation. Organized farming produces **extra food (surplus)**, which supports population growth and other professions.

Example

- Indus people grew **wheat and barley** using river water for irrigation.

4. Organized Governance

Civilizations develop systems of government to:

- Make and enforce laws
- Maintain peace and order
- Collect taxes
- Manage land and resources

Government keeps society stable and functional.

Example

- **Egyptian Pharaohs** controlled land, water, and law-making.

5. Economic Complexity

People perform different jobs such as:

- Farmers
- Traders
- Craftsmen
- Builders

Trade develops within and outside the civilization, improving wealth.

Example

- Indus traders traded beads, cotton, and pottery with **Mesopotamia**.

6. Social Stratification

Society is divided into groups based on wealth, power, or occupation. Some people enjoy more privileges than others.

Example

- Wealthy people in Indus cities lived in large houses, while poorer people lived in small homes.

7. Literacy and Writing

Writing is developed to:

- Keep records
- Write laws

- Manage trade accounts
- Preserve knowledge

Writing helps in administration and education.

Example

- **Mesopotamians** used writing to record trade and taxes.

8. Technology and Science

Civilizations invent tools and techniques to solve daily problems such as building, farming, transport, and defense.

Example

- Advanced **drainage systems** in the Indus Valley show strong engineering skills.

9. Religion and Belief Systems

Religion teaches moral values, social discipline, and unity. It helps people understand life and gives hope and purpose.

Example

- Egyptians believed in **life after death** and built pyramids for the afterlife.

10. Art and Culture

Art reflects creativity and values of society. It includes architecture, sculpture, pottery, music, and paintings.

Example

- **Indus seals** with animal figures show artistic talent.

11. Culture and Technology

Culture includes beliefs, customs, language, and traditions. Technology includes tools and machines. Together they shape civilization.

Example

- Traditional clothes and farming tools show cultural identity.

Civilization and Culture

Culture can exist **without civilization**, but civilization **cannot exist without culture**. Culture gives meaning to social life.

Example

- Tribal societies have culture but lack cities and formal governments.

Common Features and Dynamism of Civilization

Civilizations:

- Change over time
- Borrow ideas from other civilizations
- Rise and fall

Example

- Greek civilization borrowed mathematics and science from Egypt.

Evolution of the Idea of Civilization

Earlier scholars believed some civilizations were superior. Modern scholars believe **all civilizations are valuable and equal**.

Example

- Today, **Chinese, Islamic, African, and Indigenous civilizations** are respected.

Importance of Civilization

Civilization:

- Promotes cooperation
- Protects human rights
- Preserves knowledge
- Shapes identity

Example

- Modern schools, hospitals, courts, and roads are results of civilization.

INDUS VALLEY CIVILIZATION

Introduction

The Indus Valley Civilization (IVC) was one of the **earliest and most advanced civilizations of the ancient world**. It began around **3300 BC** and continued for many centuries until about **1300 BC**. It developed along the banks of the **Indus River system**.

This civilization is called a **cradle of civilization** because it shows the first clear examples of **planned cities, organized government, agriculture, trade, and social life**. People lived in permanent houses, followed rules, and worked together as a society.

The Indus Valley Civilization is especially important for **Pakistan**, because most of its major cities like **Harappa, Mohenjo-Daro, Ganeriwala, and Kot Diji** are located in present-day Pakistan.

Example

- Mohenjo-Daro was built more than 4,000 years ago, yet its town planning is better than many modern cities.

Dependence on the Indus River

The Indus River was the **backbone** of the civilization. Without the river, this civilization could not survive.

The Indus River provided:

- Clean water for drinking and daily use
- Fertile soil for farming
- Water for irrigation canals
- A natural route for travel and trade

Every year, floods brought **fertile silt**, which made the land rich for crops. This helped farmers grow more food and support a large population.

Example

- Just like Egypt depended on the Nile, the Indus people depended on the Indus River.

Discovery of the Civilization

For thousands of years, the Indus Valley Civilization remained **hidden under the ground**. People living nearby did not know the importance of the ruins.

In **1921–1922**, archaeologists led by **Sir John Marshall** excavated Harappa and Mohenjo-Daro. They discovered a civilization that was as advanced as **Egypt and Mesopotamia**.

This discovery changed world history and proved that South Asia had an ancient urban civilization.

Example

- Old bricks from Harappa were once used to build railway lines, showing how unknown the site was.

Location and Geographical Extent

The Indus Valley Civilization covered a **very large area**, making it one of the largest ancient civilizations.

It spread:

- From the **Himalayas** in the north
- To the **Arabian Sea** in the south
- From **Baluchistan** in the west
- To parts of **India and Afghanistan** in the east

The large size shows strong administration and communication between cities.

Example

- It was larger in area than both the Egyptian and Mesopotamian civilizations.

Rivers of the Indus System

The civilization was supported by many rivers:

- Indus River (main river)
- Jhelum
- Chenab
- Ravi
- Beas
- Sutlej
- Hakra (now dry)

These rivers helped people farm land, travel, and trade.

Example

- The drying of the Hakra River shows how climate change affected the civilization.

Major Cities of the Indus Valley Civilization

Harappa

Harappa was an important city located in **Punjab, Pakistan**.

Key features:

- Large granaries for storing grain
- Wide roads and strong buildings
- Centers for trade and administration

Grain storage helped people survive during floods and droughts.

Example

- Granaries show government planning for food security.

Mohenjo-Daro

Mohenjo-Daro was located in **Sindh, Pakistan** and was the largest Indus city.

The city was divided into:

- **Citadel** – public buildings
- **Lower City** – residential houses

Famous structures:

- Great Bath
- Wells
- Assembly halls

Example

- The Great Bath may have been used for religious or social ceremonies.

Town Planning and Urban Organization

Indus cities followed **scientific town planning**.

Main features:

- Grid pattern streets
- Wide main roads
- Covered drainage system
- Wells and public baths

This planning shows strong government control.

Example

- Dirty water flowed through covered drains, keeping streets clean.

Architecture and Construction

Buildings were made with **uniform baked bricks**.

Features:

- Same brick size everywhere
- Strong foundations
- Flat roofs
- Multi-room houses

No large palaces or temples were found, suggesting social equality.

Example

- Unlike Egypt, no royal palaces were discovered.

Drainage and Sanitation System

The Indus Valley had the **best sanitation system of the ancient world**.

Features:

- Bathrooms in every house
- Toilets connected to drains
- Regular cleaning of drains

Example

- Many modern cities still lack such systems.

Houses and Daily Life

People lived in brick houses arranged in blocks.

Facilities:

- Wells
- Bathrooms
- Store rooms

House size showed economic differences.

Example

- Bigger houses belonged to wealthier families.

Economic Life

The economy depended on:

- Agriculture
- Trade
- Crafts

Main crops:

- Wheat
- Barley
- Cotton

Example

- Cotton was used to make clothes and trade goods.

Trade and Transportation

Trade was well-developed.

Transport methods:

- Bullock carts
- Boats

Trade partners:

- Mesopotamia
- Iran
- Afghanistan

Example

- Lothal dockyard shows sea trade.

Trade Goods

Main trade items:

- Gold and silver
- Copper and bronze
- Beads and jewelry
- Pottery and shells

Example

- Indus seals found in Mesopotamia prove trade links.

Seals and Artifacts

Seals were used for:

- Trade
- Ownership
- Administration

They had animals and symbols.

Example

- Seals were pressed on clay to mark goods.

Technology and Innovations

Indus people were skilled engineers.

They developed:

- Standard weights
- Measuring tools

- Brick technology
- Water management

Example

- Same weights across cities show unity.

Social Life and Society

Society was:

- Peaceful
- Organized
- Less unequal

Little evidence of wars or weapons.

Example

- Few weapons found during excavations.

Religion and Beliefs

Religion was linked to nature.

Beliefs included:

- Animal worship
- Mother goddess
- Cleanliness

Example

- Animal seals may show religious symbols.

Decline of the Indus Valley Civilization

The decline was slow.

Reasons include:

1. Floods

Cities were destroyed repeatedly.

2. Climate Change

Less rainfall and dry rivers.

3. Invasions

Some signs of violence.

4. Diseases

Possible epidemics.

5. Earthquakes

River changes and city damage.

6. Social Problems

Trade declined and cities were abandoned.

Cultural Transition to Vedic Era

After decline, people moved to villages.

New features:

- Pastoral life
- New beliefs

Example

- Shift from urban to rural life.

Legacy and Importance Today

The Indus Valley Civilization:

- Is Pakistan's heritage
- Teaches city planning
- Promotes sustainability

Major sites are UNESCO World Heritage Sites.

Example

- Indus designs influence modern Pakistani art.